

INVENTORY · STACK · STRUCTURE

checklist

Items with state markers — done, partial, todo.

The checklist tracks readiness in four states.

- ✓ Done rows take a solid check
- ✓ Keep each line under ten words
- Half-done rows show the dash
- Open rows stay empty boxes
- ✍ ~~Descoped rows get the slash~~
- Eight rows is the soft ceiling

Nine rows is where the checklist overflows.

- ✓ The first rows land while attention is fresh
- ✓ Sixteen words is the budget a stress row may spend
- ✓ Three checks in a row read as momentum
- A dash admits the honest middle state
- Two dashes together flag where the risk lives
- Open boxes pull the eye forward
- Late rows stay short; the audience is counting now
- ~~○ The slash records what was cut, visibly~~
- ✓ Nine is the last row this layout seats

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When NOT to reach for checklist.

All-done lists

If every item is `[x]` the state markers are decoration. Use `list` (or its `takeaway` variant) for celebratory recaps; checklist earns its weight when the mix matters.

Long per-item prose

Each item is one short line. If a row needs a sentence of explanation, the right home is cards-stack or list-tabular.

Custom state markers

Only the six markers — `[x]` `[-]` `[!]` `[?]` `[ ]` `[/]` — map to the mark palette. Anything else in brackets (`[X]`, `[~]`, `[>]`) renders as literal text and breaks the visual contract. `[X]` is the trap: GitHub-flavored markdown reads it as a checked box, and it does not draw a mark here.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`list` — items have no state — just bullets

`list-tabular` — rows need a label-plus-description structure,
not state

`cards-stack` — each item needs two sentences of body